

3.4 Fundamentals of Python Programming

پائنتھن پروگرام اوپر سے نیچے ترتیب سے چلتا ہے۔

CS XI

Chapter 3: Programming Fundamentals

Lecture 06 of 24

★ Golden

3.4 Fundamentals of Python Programming ★ Golden

LEARN IT

The basic structure of a Python program is simple and clear. A program takes data, **processes it using statements**, and finally **shows output**. Python runs the statements **top to bottom, one after another** (sequentially).

A **statement** is one complete instruction, usually written on one line, such as `print("Hi")` or `x = 5`.

1. Comments (#) — Comments are notes written in the code **for humans**. They start with the `#` symbol. The Python interpreter completely **ignores** them. Use them to explain what your code does.

2. Indentation (spaces) — C++ and Java use curly brackets `{ }` to mark a **block** of code (a group of statements that belong together). Python instead uses **indentation**: spaces at the beginning of a line. Indentation is **mandatory** in Python. The standard is **4 spaces** (or 1 tab).

```
# This is a comment. It explains the code below.
print("Hello, World!")
if 5 > 2:
    # The space before 'print' is the indentation
    print("Five is greater than two!")
```

OUTPUT

```
Hello, World!
Five is greater than two!
```

WORKED EXAMPLE

Reading the program line by line:

1. Line 1 starts with `#`, so Python skips it.
2. Line 2 prints `Hello, World!`.
3. Line 3 asks a question: is 5 greater than 2? The colon `:` says "a block follows".
4. Line 4 is a comment inside the block (ignored).
5. Line 5 is indented by 4 spaces, so it belongs to the `if` block. Because `5 > 2` is true, it runs.

What happens if you forget the indentation?

```
if 5 > 2:
print("Five is greater than two!")
```

OUTPUT

```
File "indent.py", line 2
    print("Five is greater than two!")
    ^
IndentationError: expected an indented block after 'if' statement on line 1
```

Python refuses to run the program and points to line 2. Add 4 spaces before `print` to fix it.

REMEMBER IT

Think of indentation like the points and sub-points in your notebook. Sub-points are written a little to the right to show they "belong" to the main point. A colon `:` at the end of a line always means **"indent the next line"**.

COMMON MISTAKE

IndentationError? Check your spaces. **Mixing tabs and spaces** can break a Python program even when the code looks lined up. Choose 4 spaces and use them everywhere (VS Code inserts 4 spaces when you press Tab in a `.py` file).

اردو میں سمجھیں

پائتھن پروگرام اوپر سے نیچے ترتیب سے چلتا ہے۔ `#` سے شروع ہونے والی لائن تبصرہ (Comment) ہوتی ہے جسے پائتھن نظر انداز کر دیتا ہے۔ پائتھن میں کوڈ کے بلاک کو بریکٹ کے بجائے انڈینٹیشن (Indentation) یعنی لائن کے شروع میں چار خالی جگہوں سے ظاہر کیا جاتا ہے، اور یہ لازمی ہے۔

EXAM TIP

Common questions: "What is the purpose of comments?", "Why is indentation important in Python?", "How is Python different from C++/Java in defining blocks?" Write: comments start with `#` and are ignored by the interpreter; Python uses indentation (4 spaces) instead of `{ }`; wrong indentation gives an `IndentationError`. Always give a 3–4 line code example.

CHECK YOURSELF

1. Predict the output:

```
# print("A")
print("B")
if 3 > 7:
    print("C")
print("D")
```

2. What is the standard amount of indentation in Python?

Answers: 1. B then D on separate lines (line 1 is a comment; `3 > 7` is false so C is skipped). 2. 4 spaces (or 1 tab).

Next lecture: 3.4.1 Variables